

**IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF THE EIGHTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT
IN AND FOR ALACHUA COUNTY, FLORIDA**

CASE NO.: 01-2026-CA-001794

CHRISTOPHER A. HANSON,
individually and as attorney for
himself and next friend and attorney
for his two minor children,
Petitioners,

v.

UNIVERSITY OF FLORIDA BOARD
OF TRUSTEES, and CUSTODIAN
OF PUBLIC RECORDS, UNIVERSITY
OF FLORIDA,
Respondents.

**PETITIONER'S REPLY TO RESPONDENTS' RESPONSE TO ORDER TO SHOW
CAUSE**

Petitioner, Christopher A. Hanson, replies to the University's Response to the Verified Petition for Writ of Mandamus (the "Petition"), filed pursuant to this Court's Order to Show Cause dated June 12, 2026 (the "Order"), and states:

Introduction

1. This reply is timely. The Order provides that "[u]pon the filing of the response, Petitioners shall have seven (7) days in which to file a reply, should they so choose." (Order ¶ 3.) The Response was filed July 7, 2026; this reply follows within seven days.

2. The Response calls this case "simple," reducing it to: "Petitioner asked for public records about himself, and the University produced the requested records to Petitioner." It then dismisses Petitioner as "convinced, despite a complete lack of evidence, that the University has wrongfully withheld or redacted records." (Response p. 1.)

3. Both halves of that framing are refuted by the University's own filing. The evidence of withholding is the University's own sworn affidavit — the affidavit of John Hines, the University's Director of Public Records and records custodian (the "Hines Affidavit") — which states that the University located "over 470 pages" of documents and delivered a production consisting of 53 pages of Petitioner's own correspondence. (Hines Aff. ¶¶ 2, 6–8.)

4. The facts as the University pleads them are that at least 417 pages were withheld — without explanation, identification, or even a firm page count of how much was withheld. Further, given the University's purported concerns about producing irrelevant information to Petitioner, its decision to produce back to Petitioner only materials he necessarily already possessed (his own correspondence with University officials) raises more important questions requiring discovery.

5. And the premise — that Petitioner "asked for public records about himself" — is not the request Petitioner made, as the Response's own second page proves. The March 26, 2026 request — which the Response reproduces in full (Response p. 2) — sought records "related to myself and ongoing litigation for which I sought help from the Brechner Institute," directed at records maintained by, sent to, or received by employees within the UF College of Journalism and Communications, specifically including the Brechner Freedom of Information Project, Dr. David Cuillier, and Professor Jane Bambauer. (Pet. ¶¶ 11, 14; Appendix to the Petition ("App.") 4.)

6. The request defined three categories of search terms: (A) Petitioner's names and contact information; (B) six enumerated case numbers from Petitioner's pending litigation; and (C) eleven targeted keywords, individuals, and subjects — among them "13th Circuit," the

names of three judges, "Florida Bar Mandamus," "surveillance video," and "insider protectionism." (App. 4; Response p. 2.)

7. Records responsive to Categories B and C are not "records about" Petitioner. They are records about pending litigation involving the concealment of public records — the very subject on which Petitioner sought the assistance of the Brechner Freedom of Information Project (Pet. ¶ 11) — and about the University's own communications concerning it. The request expressly demanded those internal communications, and Petitioner's follow-up correspondence expressly renewed the demand. (Pet. ¶¶ 15, 20; App. 75.)

8. A university that recasts that request as "public records about himself," searches the recast version, and returns the requester his own emails cannot credibly cast Petitioner's concern over the concealment of relevant records as baseless. The Public Records Act leaves no room for an agency to withhold what a lawful request reaches based on the agency's own assessment of whether the records "relate to" the requester. (Pet. ¶ 27.)

9. The misstatement in the Response's first sentence is not a slip; it is the same interpretive move that produced the deficient search the Petition challenges. Section I below addresses the search the Response never accounts for; Section II, the 417-page gap in the University's own affidavit; Section III, its waiver theory; Section IV, the sequence of remedies; and Section V, its remaining points.

I. The Response never accounts for the search the request required — and its silence on the Category B and C search terms speaks.

10. The Petition squarely alleged: "The University's written responses have identified only one search term having been run: the bare surname 'Hanson.' No University communication has addressed or accounted for Category B of the request (the six enumerated case numbers tied

to Petitioner's litigation) or Category C (the targeted keywords, individuals, and subjects ...), and the University has never stated whether any search of those categories was performed, what was searched, or whether responsive records exist." (Pet. ¶ 21.)

11. The Order stated that the University's response "should include the factual and legal basis and address all issues contained in the petition." (Order ¶ 2.) On this issue — the central issue — the Response says nothing. Neither the Response nor the Hines Affidavit ever states which search terms were run.

12. Both offer only the formula that UFIT — the University's information-technology unit — searched "using the terms identified in Petitioner's request" (Hines Aff. ¶ 6; Response p. 3): a sentence that names no term, no case number, no keyword, and no system. Whether the Order's instruction is read as directory or mandatory, the inference is the same: a response prepared with the University's legal department, which engages every other point in the Petition but omits the one dispositive, one-sentence fact — "we ran the six case numbers and the eleven keywords" — invites the conclusion that the sentence could not truthfully be written. The Court should treat Paragraph 21 as unrebutted unless the University now proves otherwise.

13. The University's own correspondence corroborates that inference three times over, in sequence. Its intake acknowledgment disclosed a self-imposed limitation at the outset: "Email searches will not include attachments unless specifically requested." (App. 8.) Its May 5, 2026 email described the entire methodology as "reaching out to the employees you identified and to UF IT to conduct email searches" (App. 76) — email searches only, though the request expressly covered text and SMS messages, Signal and WhatsApp messages, collaboration platforms, internal memoranda, notes, draft research materials, and personal devices or private email accounts used for University business. (Pet. ¶¶ 15, 21; Pet. Prayer (a)(ii).) And its May 8, 2026

email identified the one term it had run: the University "did locate public records that contain the search term 'Hanson,' which relate to individuals who are not you, but have the same last name." (App. 74.) The Response addresses none of this.

14. Nor does the inference rest on silence alone; the record affirmatively supports it. The Petition alleges, under oath, that in telephone conversations Dr. Cuillier "displayed familiarity with aspects of Petitioner's litigation and objectives that Petitioner had not shared with him, supporting the inference that responsive internal University communications concerning Petitioner exist and have not been produced." (Pet. ¶ 12.)

15. The one witness positioned to answer that allegation — the custodian, under oath — did not deny it. He swore only that Dr. Cuillier and Professor Bambauer "sent me records that consisted of email correspondence with Petitioner." (Hines Aff. ¶ 6.)

16. Correspondence with Petitioner is not internal University communication about Petitioner's cases — the material Category C reaches and Paragraph 12 says exists. On the University's own affidavit, that category was neither searched on the record nor accounted for.

17. This is precisely the deficiency the Petition's prayer targets: a sworn certification "describ[ing] the search methodology, the specific search terms used, and every custodian, location, system, and repository searched" (Pet. Prayer (a)(ii)), and production responsive to "each of the three defined categories ... and not merely records containing the bare surname 'Hanson'" (Pet. Prayer (a)(iii); Pet. p. 5). The Response's silence does not answer those issues; it confirms they remain open.

II. On the University's own sworn account, it located "over 470 pages," produced 53 — all of them Petitioner's own correspondence — and accounted for the difference in two conclusory sentences.

18. The University's custodian swears that UFIT, "using the terms identified in Petitioner's request, gathered over 470 pages of documents, including Petitioner's correspondence with UF faculty." (Hines Aff. ¶ 6; accord Response p. 3.) He further swears that he "worked with UFIT and UF's legal department to parse through the 470+ pages," and that "[o]f these, some records did not meet the definition of public records, while others concerned individuals having the surname Hanson, but with no relation to the Petitioner." (Hines Aff. ¶ 7; accord Response p. 3.)

19. The University's May 4, 2026 delivery totaled 53 pages (Ex. D to the Petition; App. 13–65), and the University "made no further production." (Response p. 4.) The 53 pages are the "Petitioner's correspondence with UF faculty" the affidavit describes: Petitioner's own email exchanges, by definition already in his possession, returned to him. (Hines Aff. ¶ 6.) The affidavit's own phrasing shows on its face that the located set was broader: UFIT gathered over 470 pages "*including* Petitioner's correspondence with UF faculty" (Hines Aff. ¶ 6 (emphasis added)) — yet the correspondence is all that came back.

20. And "over 470" is a floor, not an accounting. On the University's own numbers, at least 417 located pages were withheld. The University states no precise count of what it located, no count of what it withheld, no breakdown between its two offered grounds ("not public records" / "other Hansons"), and no identification of a single withheld document. Its only offered accounting is a promise: "These documents will be provided to the Court upon request for an *in camera* review." (Response p. 3 n.5.)

21. The University's own words confirm that what stood between the 470-plus located pages and the 53 produced was a substantive, discretionary review — not a ministerial pass-through. Its May 5 email, which the Response itself quotes, states: "In accordance with the law

and normal UF process, all located records incurred a legal review in order to determine responsiveness and the potential exempt nature of information in the records. No exempt information was withheld or redacted from the records responsive to your request, and consequently, no statutory exemptions were cited in UF's response." (App. 76; accord Response p. 4.)

22. On that account, every located page was screened by the University's legal department for responsiveness and exemption; no statutory exemption was ever invoked; and everything withheld was therefore withheld on the University's own characterization of the records — that they were "not public records," or not "responsive," or concerned "other Hansons." Those are not exemptions. They are legal conclusions about the records' status and scope — conclusions the University asks Petitioner and this Court to accept sight unseen.

23. That posture defeats denial. The University itself supplies the governing rule, quoting *Chandler v. City of Greenacres*, 140 So. 3d 1080, 1083 (Fla. 4th DCA 2014) (quoting *Smith v. State*, 696 So. 2d 814, 816 (Fla. 2d DCA 1997)): "once an alternative writ has issued, the burden is on the respondent to come forth with facts upon which it refused to perform its legal duty." (Response p. 5.) This Court's Order — which directs the University to "show cause in writing why a peremptory writ should not issue" (Order ¶ 2), the alternative-writ procedure the Petition requested (Pet. Prayer (b)) — places the University in precisely that posture. Two sentences asserting that an unstated number of unidentified documents "did not meet the definition of public records" or "concerned individuals having the surname Hanson" (Hines Aff. ¶ 7) are legal conclusions, not facts the Court can test.

24. The affidavit does not define "public records," does not explain why any particular document fails the definition, and does not say what its "legal review" screened out or why. The University simply asks the Court to trust it.

III. The "Petitioner declined the records" defense answers only the surname "Hanson" — and the University's own framing of that exchange left Petitioner in the dark about everything else.

25. The centerpiece of the Response is that Petitioner "declined the records he now seeks." (Response p. 5.) That argument is directed entirely at one thing: records that hit on the bare surname "Hanson" but concern other people named Hanson. The University "reasonably interpreted Petitioner's request for 'public records related to myself' as not including public records related to other individuals named 'Hanson,'" asked Petitioner to confirm, and quotes his confirmation: "I am not seeking records about unrelated third parties who happen to share my surname." (Response pp. 5–6.)

26. The University's own account of its May 8 clarification confirms the exchange's narrow scope: it describes asking "whether Petitioner wanted records that did not appear responsive as they related to different individuals with the last name 'Hanson.'" (Response p. 4.) Petitioner does not retreat from his answer. He declined records about other people named Hanson — and, on the University's own description of its own question, only those.

27. Petitioner's very same May 8 response — the document the University quotes his "declination" from — restated the request's three categories, stated that "I am seeking records responsive to those categories," and expressly demanded "Internal University communications, memoranda, notes, or drafts referencing the case numbers, individuals, or keywords I identified." (App. 75.)

28. It went further: it asked the University point-blank to "confirm whether the University has any records responsive to my public records request even if the University finds that they 'relate' to someone else." (App. 75.) The University never answered that question. The University's presentation of that exchange as a waiver reads one sentence of the letter and ignores the rest of the page.

29. A document responsive to a Category B case number or a Category C keyword is not a record about an unrelated third party who happens to share Petitioner's surname. Those terms identify Petitioner's own cases and the named subjects of his request. The surname-"Hanson" cull the University describes therefore does not, on the University's own account of it, reach Category B or Category C at all — yet the Response and the Hines Affidavit never say whether Categories B and C were searched, what they returned, or what became of any hits. (Pet. ¶ 21; § I above.)

30. The exchange also matters for what it did to Petitioner's understanding. The University's May 8 email presented the withheld located records as records that "relate to individuals who are not you" (App. 74) — other people's records, take them or leave them — and disclosed no other withheld category.

31. Its two interim emails answered only that question: the May 5 email offered general assurances about a "good faith search," and the May 8 email asked about the other Hansons; neither responded to the May 4 statutory notice's actual demands — the certification, the identification of withheld records, and the internal communications. (App. 67–68, 74, 76.)

32. Petitioner answered the question the University actually asked, renewed his demands, and heard nothing further by the notice's May 11 deadline — or at all, until the University's litigation filings disclosed under oath that its located set ran to "over 470 pages." (Pet. ¶¶ 20–23.)

An agency cannot describe its withholdings to the requester as other people's records, go silent, and then convert the requester's reliance on that description into a waiver of everything else.

IV. The located records should be produced and the withholdings identified; the search must be tested by discovery; in camera review is reserved for claimed exemptions.

33. The University is correct that a public-records request reaches only public records, and that not everything on an agency's servers qualifies. (Response pp. 7–8, citing *Shevin v. Byron, Harless*, 379 So. 2d 633 (Fla. 1980); *State v. City of Clearwater*, 863 So. 2d 149 (Fla. 2003); *Bent v. State*, 46 So. 3d 1047 (Fla. 4th DCA 2010).) Petitioner does not quarrel with that law.

34. The problem is the University's application of it: an unquantified, unidentified, self-administered cull of at least 417 located pages, offered to the Court as a conclusion it should accept on faith. The University's own authorities treat the public-record classification as a question of law for the courts, decided case by case: "The determination of whether something is a public record is a question of law subject to de novo review and is determined on a case-by-case basis." *Bent*, 46 So. 3d at 1049 (citing *City of Clearwater*, 863 So. 2d at 151; *Shevin*, 379 So. 2d at 640). In *Shevin* itself, the disputed papers were impounded, sealed, and examined by the courts, which classified them under the "intended to perpetuate, communicate, or formalize knowledge" test the Court announced. 379 So. 2d at 640. None of the University's cases lets the custodian's own characterization end the inquiry.

35. The University's own authority supplies the accounting duty. It quotes Section 119.07(1)(e): "If the person who has custody of a public record contends that all or part of the record is exempt from inspection and copying, he or she shall state the basis of the exemption" (Response p. 7 (emphasis added by the University); accord Pet. ¶ 26.) And it invokes the rule

that the responding party must "come forth with facts." (Response p. 5, quoting *Chandler*.) An agency that has located search-hit documents and elected not to produce them — whether it labels the ground "exempt," "not a public record," or "unrelated" — must give the requester and the Court enough to test that decision: an identification of each withheld document by description, date, author, and recipients, and the specific ground asserted for it. Petitioner does not ask the Court to engraft a certification or "privilege log" requirement onto Chapter 119; he asks the Court to require the facts *Chandler* and the Order already call for, in the only form in which facts about withheld documents can exist.

36. *Jones v. Miami Herald Media Co.*, 198 So. 3d 1143 (Fla. 1st DCA 2016), and *Dettelbach v. Department of Business & Professional Regulation*, 261 So. 3d 676 (Fla. 1st DCA 2018) (Response pp. 8–10), do not hold otherwise. *Jones* held that Section 119.07(1)(e) requires "only record-by-record — not redaction-by-redaction — identification of the exemptions" *within records the agency produced*, 198 So. 3d at 1146 — and it expressly declined to construe Section 119.07(1)(f), *id.* at 1146 n.4, while leaving the trial court's in camera review of the disputed redactions intact, *id.* at 1144 n.2. In *Dettelbach*, the agency identified the specific statutory exemption it claimed for the withheld memorandum, bore the burden of proving it, and had the claim adjudicated by the court — the First District rejected only a freestanding indexing duty, not judicial testing. *See* 261 So. 3d at 683 (the pin the University itself cites, Response p. 10).

37. Here, by contrast, the University has invoked no statutory exemption at all (Response p. 9; App. 76), identified nothing, and asks the Court to accept its unadjudicated characterizations on faith. Neither case licenses that. Nor is record-identification some litigation-born novelty: the request itself asked, on March 26, that "[f]or any withheld record" the University provide the "date, author, recipient, and general subject matter," with any claimed

exemption stated in writing and its statutory basis cited. (App. 8; Pet. ¶ 15.) The University answered that request with nothing. And its repeated assurance that it "did not redact any information" and produced responsive records "in their entirety" (Response p. 9) only sharpens the point: whatever is missing was withheld whole, invisibly, and the only way anyone — Petitioner or the Court — can test whether it was properly withheld is for the University to say what it is, and for the Court to look. *See Walton v. Dugger*, 634 So. 2d 1059, 1061–62 (Fla. 1993) (where doubt exists whether a document must be disclosed, the court resolves the question on inspection and an evidentiary record).

38. The exemption framework — not agency relabeling — governs what happens to located records, and the burden under it is the University's: "The state has the burden of showing that requested documents fall within the statutory requirements for exemption from disclosure under the Act." *Dettelbach*, 261 So. 3d at 683 (citing *Lightbourne v. McCollum*, 969 So. 2d 326, 333 (Fla. 2007)). The Public Records Act "is to be construed liberally in favor of openness, and all exemptions from disclosure are to be construed narrowly and limited in their designated purpose." *Lightbourne*, 969 So. 2d at 332–33 (quoting *City of Riviera Beach v. Barfield*, 642 So. 2d 1135, 1136 (Fla. 4th DCA 1994)). Exemptions must be stated with their specific statutory basis (§ 119.07(1)(e)), and an agency cannot escape that framework — and its burden — by relabeling its withholding decisions, en masse, as "non-record" determinations. As to the one category of withheld documents the University has actually described, its own words concede the point: its May 8 email told Petitioner that the University "did locate *public records* that contain the search term 'Hanson,' which relate to individuals who are not you." (App. 74 (emphasis added).) Public records, on the University's own description — leaving only the question of exemption, and the University claims none. (Response p. 9; App. 76.)

39. Nor is this a case in which an exemption might yet emerge. Directed by the Order to state the "factual and legal basis" for its position (Order ¶ 2), the University stated no exemption — it disclaimed one, affirmatively and repeatedly: "No exempt information was withheld or redacted from the records responsive to your request, and consequently, no statutory exemptions were cited in UF's response" (App. 76); the University "did not redact any information in its production to Petitioner or withhold any documents on the basis of a privilege" (Response p. 9); and the Hines Affidavit identifies no exemption for any withheld page. The University has litigated this case on the position that no exemption applies. It should be held to that position. An exemption first asserted after production is ordered would contradict the University's own account, and the University would bear the burden of proving it. *Lightbourne*, 969 So. 2d at 333.

40. Judicial review of the located set should therefore begin now — and it need not be secret. In camera inspection is the procedure for testing a *claimed exemption* without disclosing the record. The University claims no exemption. For documents it merely labels non-responsive or "not public records," the straightforward course is production: to Petitioner, with the set simultaneously lodged with the Court, and with in camera treatment reserved for any specific page the University identifies as exempt, by description and statutory citation. That order requires no hearing. And it resolves only what the existing search found — it is without prejudice to the search-completeness dispute (§ I), because review of a defective search's output cannot validate the search. If the completed searches locate additional records, the same treatment — production, or identified exemptions tested in camera — should follow.

41. Targeted discovery is the efficient path to testing the search, and its timing should structure the schedule. On July 13, 2026, Petitioner served on the University, through its counsel, a first set of interrogatories, requests for admission, and a request to produce, each directed

narrowly at the mechanics the Response leaves unstated: who performed each search, on what systems and repositories, using which of the request's enumerated terms, returning how many pages, and what became of each category of hits. (Composite Exhibit A (the three instruments as served, each with its July 13, 2026 certificate of service).)

42. Petitioner asks the Court to confirm that this discovery may proceed, with responses due within the time the rules of civil procedure already provide — thirty days from the July 13 service, or by August 12, 2026 — and to grant Petitioner leave to take two short depositions, noticed and completed within that same period: the University's records custodian, John Hines, and a designee of UFIT with knowledge of the searches actually performed. The University has placed its search process in issue by affidavit; the disputed, material facts it left unstated should be established by testimony and documents, not assumed, before the Court is asked to accept the search's output.

43. Petitioner does not retreat from the priority Section 119.11(1) affords this action — he invokes it. But the statute's priority exists to produce a prompt and *meaningful* determination, and a hearing held before the University has answered a single question about its search would be a hearing on an untested affidavit — the University's preferred record, not a complete one. Petitioner therefore asks the Court to set the schedule now, at an immediate case-management conference, and to set the evidentiary hearing for the earliest practicable date after the discovery period closes — no earlier than fourteen days after the later of the University's discovery responses and the completion of the depositions — so that the parties and the Court come to the hearing with the search's actual facts in hand.

V. The remaining points do not support denial.

44. Custodian. The University identifies John Hines as its Director of Public Records and records custodian, under oath, and shows his designation published on its public-records website. (Response pp. 10–13; Hines Aff. ¶¶ 2–3.) Petitioner accepts the designation. But the designation answers the wrong question — and Petitioner's contemporaneous correspondence shows it was never his question. On May 8 he wrote that the University had "responded to my correspondence three times without identifying any human being responsible for the positions it is taking.

45. No custodian has been named. No designee has been named. No author of any of the University's responses has been named." (App. 74.) The Response's website-placement argument answers the label; it does not answer the person.

46. The affidavit itself shows that Mr. Hines did not perform the searches: he "sent the search parameters" to UFIT and to two faculty members (Hines Aff. ¶ 5), and UFIT "gathered" the documents (¶ 6).

47. No one — not the Response, not the affidavit — identifies who at UFIT ran the searches, what they ran, or on what systems. It is not reasonable to assume that the single designated custodian of an institution the size of the University of Florida personally executes every search connected to a records request; the statute's duties are discharged through people whose work the custodian relays.

48. The identity and methodology of those people is exactly what the Petition's certification demand (Pet. Prayer (a)(i)–(ii)) and the discovery described above are for. The University's estoppel argument — that Petitioner's Section 119.12(1)(b) notice shows he knew who the custodian was (Response pp. 12–13) — misses the point on this posture. Petitioner expressly reserves all issues of entitlement under Section 119.12, which are not before the Court at the show-cause stage, and the argument does nothing to cure the production gap, which is.

Conclusion

49. The stakes here are not confined to Petitioner. Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution and Chapter 119 exist so that the public can see how its government — including its flagship public university — conducts the public's business. The records at issue concern how that university's own Brechner Freedom of Information Project responded when a citizen brought it documented concerns about the concealment of public records (Pet. ¶ 11), and how the University then handled the request that followed. If an agency may narrow a request to its least revealing reading, run one search term of many, withhold at least 417 located pages on unexplained characterizations, and call the matter closed, the accountability those provisions guarantee is not worth much — for any requester.

50. The University's Response does not entitle it to denial.

51. Its first sentence recasts a three-category request about Petitioner's litigation — and the University's own communications concerning it — as a request for "records about himself."

52. Its search, on its own correspondence, ran one evidenced term of the many the request enumerated, by email only, excluding attachments.

53. Its own sworn account locates "over 470 pages," produces 53 — every one of them correspondence already in Petitioner's possession — and, having screened every located page through a "legal review" that invoked no statutory exemption, accounts for the at least 417 withheld pages in two conclusory sentences, with no count, no identification, and no stated basis a court can test.

54. And on the central allegation that Categories B and C were never searched, the Response — invited by this Court to address all issues in the Petition — says nothing at all.

55. Petitioner asks the Court to order the sequence set out above: immediate production of the located set to Petitioner and the Court, with in camera review reserved for any exemption the University actually claims; preservation; the certified, complete search; the itemized accounting of anything withheld; the discovery and depositions, completed within the rules' own thirty-day period; the Section 119.11(1) hearing on that complete record; and the same production-or-claimed-exemption treatment for whatever the completed searches locate.

WHEREFORE, Petitioner respectfully requests that this Court:

- (a) Order Respondents, within seven (7) days and without the need for a hearing, to produce to Petitioner, and simultaneously lodge with the Court, the more than 470 pages of located documents the University's custodian identifies (Hines Aff. ¶ 6) — provided that any specific page Respondents contend is exempt shall instead be identified by description and specific statutory citation (§ 119.07(1)(e), Fla. Stat.) and lodged for in camera inspection — such production and review being without prejudice to the search-completeness issues raised in Sections I and IV, and with the search term each page matched identified as an aid to review, within the Court's discretion;
- (b) Order Respondents to preserve, pending resolution of this action, all located documents, search outputs, and records of the searches performed (Pet. Prayer (d));
- (c) Set an immediate case-management conference, in keeping with the priority Section 119.11(1), Florida Statutes, affords this action, to establish the schedule requested below;
- (d) Order Respondents to perform and certify, under oath, a complete search responsive to each of the three categories of the March 26, 2026 request — describing the methodology, the specific terms run, and every custodian, system, and repository

- searched, including the non-email channels the request enumerated (Pet. Prayer (a)(ii)–(iii)) — within the same period provided for their discovery responses;
- (e) Order Respondents to identify, in writing and within that same period, each document located in any search and withheld from production — by description, date, author, and recipient(s) — together with the specific ground asserted for withholding it;
- (f) Confirm that the targeted discovery Petitioner served on July 13, 2026 (Composite Ex. A) may proceed, with responses due within the time the rules provide — thirty days from service, or by August 12, 2026 — and grant Petitioner leave to take the depositions of records custodian John Hines and a UFIT designee with knowledge of the searches performed, to be noticed and completed within that same period;
- (g) Set the Section 119.11(1) evidentiary hearing for the earliest practicable date that is no earlier than fourteen (14) days after the later of (i) Respondents' service of complete discovery responses and production and (ii) the completion of the depositions, so that the hearing proceeds on a complete and tested record;
- (h) Order that any additional records located by the completed searches receive the same treatment as paragraph (a): production to Petitioner and the Court, with in camera inspection reserved for any page withheld under a specifically cited exemption;
- (i) Decline the University's request to deny the Petition on its Response and affidavit alone, and reserve jurisdiction over Petitioner's entitlement to costs and attorney's fees under Sections 119.11 and 119.12, Florida Statutes; and
- (j) Grant such other and further relief as the Court deems just and proper.

Respectfully submitted this 14th day of July, 2026.

/s/ Christopher A. Hanson
Christopher A. Hanson, Esq.

Florida Bar No. 44094
cahanson77@yahoo.com
727-409-5738
Self-represented Petitioner

CERTIFICATE OF SERVICE

I HEREBY CERTIFY that on this 14th day of July, 2026, a true and correct copy of the foregoing was served through the Florida Courts E-Filing Portal on James W. Kirkconnell, Esq., Attorney for the University of Florida, jameswk@ufl.edu, 123 Tigert Hall, PO Box 113125, Gainesville, FL 32611-3125.

/s/ Christopher A. Hanson
Christopher A. Hanson, Esq.

COMPOSITE EXHIBIT A

Petitioner's First Set of Interrogatories,
First Requests for Admission, and First Request to Produce,
each served on Respondents through counsel on July 13, 2026

Hanson v. University of Florida Board of Trustees, et al.,
Case No. 01-2026-CA-001794 (Fla. 8th Jud. Cir.)

**IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF THE EIGHTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT
IN AND FOR ALACHUA COUNTY, FLORIDA**

CASE NO.: 01-2026-CA-001794

CHRISTOPHER A. HANSON,
individually and as attorney for
himself and next friend and attorney
for his two minor children,

Petitioners,

v.

UNIVERSITY OF FLORIDA BOARD
OF TRUSTEES, and CUSTODIAN
OF PUBLIC RECORDS, UNIVERSITY
OF FLORIDA,

Respondents.

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PETITIONER'S FIRST SET OF INTERROGATORIES TO RESPONDENTS

Petitioner, Christopher A. Hanson, pursuant to Florida Rule of Civil Procedure 1.340, propounds the following interrogatories to Respondents, the University of Florida Board of Trustees and the Custodian of Public Records, University of Florida (collectively, the "University"), to be answered separately and fully in writing under oath within thirty (30) days of service.

Definitions

1. **"Request"** means the public-records request assigned tracking number W018463-032626, submitted by Petitioner on or about March 26, 2026, including its Categories A, B, and C as reproduced at page 2 of the University's Response.
2. **"UFIT"** means the University of Florida Information Technology unit referenced in paragraph 6 of the Affidavit of John Hines.
3. **"Gathered pages"** means the over 470 pages of documents UFIT located in response to the Request (Hines Aff. ¶ 6). **"Produced pages"** means the documents delivered to Petitioner on

May 4, 2026. **"Identify,"** as to a person, means state the person's name, title, and role; as to a document or communication, means state its date, author, recipients, and subject.

Instructions

4. Answer each interrogatory separately and fully in writing under oath, or object with specificity, within thirty (30) days of service. Rule 1.340(a). If any answer would change, the University is under a continuing duty to supplement. This action is entitled to statutory priority under Section 119.11(1), Florida Statutes; consistent with that priority and Petitioner's accompanying letter, Petitioner requests expedited answers.

Interrogatories

INTERROGATORY NO. 1. Identify each search term the University or UFIT actually ran in response to the Request. For each term, state: (a) the exact term or query as run; (b) the date it was run; (c) the system, database, or repository against which it was run; (d) the scope searched (including each custodian, mailbox, account, or drive covered); and (e) the number of items or pages it returned. (f) If any term identified in the Request — including any of the six Category B case numbers or the Category C keywords, individuals, and subjects reproduced at page 2 of the Response — was NOT run, identify each such term and state why it was not run.

INTERROGATORY NO. 2. Identify each person who performed the searches described in your answer to Interrogatory No. 1; each person who reviewed or "parse[d] through" the gathered pages (Hines Aff. ¶ 7); and each person who authored, sent, or approved any communication to Petitioner concerning the Request; and state the criteria applied in determining whether each gathered page was produced, withheld as a non-record, or withheld as concerning an unrelated individual.

INTERROGATORY NO. 3. State the total number of pages the University produced to Petitioner in response to the Request and the total number of gathered pages the University did not produce; and for the pages not produced, state the number attributable to each stated ground — (a) not a public record, (b) concerning an individual with the surname "Hanson" unrelated to Petitioner, and (c) any other ground, describing that ground.

INTERROGATORY NO. 4. Describe the form and location in which the UFIT search outputs are maintained, including the file format(s), the system(s) on which they are stored, whether they can be exported, and the identity of the person or unit that maintains them.

INTERROGATORY NO. 5. Identify every repository, system, account, or device within the University's custody or control that was NOT searched in response to the Request but that could contain records responsive to it — including without limitation email accounts, text-message and instant-messaging platforms, shared network drives, cloud storage, and any personal accounts or devices used by University personnel to conduct University business.

INTERROGATORY NO. 6. Identify each person who participated in the decision not to produce the balance of the gathered pages, and for each, state that person's role in the decision.

INTERROGATORY NO. 7. State whether any gathered page has been altered, deleted, moved, overwritten, or become unavailable since it was located in response to the Request; and if so, identify each such page and describe what occurred, when, and by whom.

INTERROGATORY NO. 8. Identify each communication (excluding communications protected by the attorney-client privilege or work-product doctrine, which shall be logged) in which any person determined that a gathered page was not a public record or concerned an unrelated individual, stating the date of each such communication and its participants.

CERTIFICATE OF SERVICE

I HEREBY CERTIFY that on this 13th day of July, 2026, a true and correct copy of the foregoing was served through the Florida Courts E-Filing Portal and by email on James W. Kirkconnell, Esq., Attorney for the University of Florida, jameswk@ufl.edu, 123 Tigert Hall, PO Box 113125, Gainesville, FL 32611-3125.

/s/ Christopher A. Hanson

Christopher A. Hanson, Esq.

**IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF THE EIGHTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT
IN AND FOR ALACHUA COUNTY, FLORIDA**

CASE NO.: 01-2026-CA-001794

CHRISTOPHER A. HANSON,
individually and as attorney for
himself and next friend and attorney
for his two minor children,

Petitioners,

v.

UNIVERSITY OF FLORIDA BOARD
OF TRUSTEES, and CUSTODIAN
OF PUBLIC RECORDS, UNIVERSITY
OF FLORIDA,

Respondents.

_____ /

PETITIONER'S FIRST REQUESTS FOR ADMISSION TO RESPONDENTS

Petitioner, Christopher A. Hanson, pursuant to Florida Rule of Civil Procedure 1.370, requests that Respondents, the University of Florida Board of Trustees and the Custodian of Public Records, University of Florida (collectively, the "University"), admit or deny the truth of each of the following matters within thirty (30) days of service.

Definitions

1. **"Request"** means the public-records request assigned tracking number W018463-032626, submitted by Petitioner on or about March 26, 2026, including its Categories A, B, and C as reproduced at page 2 of the University's Response to the Verified Petition.
2. **"UFIT"** means the University of Florida Information Technology unit referenced in paragraph 6 of the Affidavit of John Hines.
3. **"Gathered pages"** means the "over 470 pages of documents" the University's custodian swears UFIT located in response to the Request. (Hines Aff. ¶ 6.)

4. **"Produced pages"** means the documents the University delivered to Petitioner on May 4, 2026.

Instructions

5. Each matter is admitted unless, within thirty (30) days after service, the University serves a written answer or objection addressed to the matter, signed by the party or its attorney, as required by Rule 1.370(a). If the University cannot truthfully admit or deny a matter, it must state in detail why it cannot, and a denial must fairly meet the substance of the requested admission, qualifying an answer or admitting part and denying the remainder where a good-faith response so requires. Rule 1.370(a).

6. This action is a public-records mandamus proceeding entitled to statutory priority over other pending matters under Section 119.11(1), Florida Statutes. Consistent with that priority, and as set out in Petitioner's accompanying letter, Petitioner requests expedited responses in advance of the thirty-day period.

Requests for Admission

REQUEST NO. 1. In response to the Request, UFIT gathered over 470 pages of documents.

REQUEST NO. 2. UFIT gathered those pages using terms identified in the Request.

REQUEST NO. 3. The University's May 4, 2026 production to Petitioner consisted of two documents — an attachment of 50 pages and an attachment of 3 pages.

REQUEST NO. 4. The two documents produced on May 4, 2026 together total 53 pages.

REQUEST NO. 5. The University has produced no records to Petitioner in response to the Request beyond those 53 pages.

REQUEST NO. 6. The 53 produced pages consist entirely of correspondence to or from Petitioner.

REQUEST NO. 7. The University has not asserted any statutory exemption under Section 119.07, Florida Statutes, as to any record located in response to the Request.

REQUEST NO. 8. The University has not provided Petitioner an index, log, or count of the gathered pages.

REQUEST NO. 9. The University maintains records of the searches UFIT performed in response to the Request, including the queries run and/or their outputs.

REQUEST NO. 10. The gathered pages that the University did not produce to Petitioner have not been provided to the Court.

Respectfully submitted this 13th day of July, 2026.

/s/ Christopher A. Hanson

Christopher A. Hanson, Esq.

Florida Bar No. 44094

cahanson77@yahoo.com

727-409-5738

Self-represented Petitioner

CERTIFICATE OF SERVICE

I HEREBY CERTIFY that on this ____ day of July, 2026, a true and correct copy of the foregoing was served through the Florida Courts E-Filing Portal and by email on James W. Kirkconnell, Esq., Attorney for the University of Florida, jameswk@ufl.edu, 123 Tigert Hall, PO Box 113125, Gainesville, FL 32611-3125.

/s/ Christopher A. Hanson

Christopher A. Hanson, Esq.

**IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF THE EIGHTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT
IN AND FOR ALACHUA COUNTY, FLORIDA**

CASE NO.: 01-2026-CA-001794

CHRISTOPHER A. HANSON,
individually and as attorney for
himself and next friend and attorney
for his two minor children,

Petitioners,

v.

UNIVERSITY OF FLORIDA BOARD
OF TRUSTEES, and CUSTODIAN
OF PUBLIC RECORDS, UNIVERSITY
OF FLORIDA,

Respondents.

_____ /

PETITIONER'S FIRST REQUEST TO PRODUCE TO RESPONDENTS

Petitioner, Christopher A. Hanson, pursuant to Florida Rule of Civil Procedure 1.350, requests that Respondents, the University of Florida Board of Trustees and the Custodian of Public Records, University of Florida (collectively, the "University"), produce for inspection and copying the following items within thirty (30) days of service, at the offices of Petitioner or by electronic delivery in native format.

Definitions

1. **"Request"** means the public-records request assigned tracking number W018463-032626, submitted on or about March 26, 2026, including Categories A, B, and C. **"UFIT"** means the University of Florida Information Technology unit (Hines Aff. ¶ 6). **"Gathered pages"** means the over 470 pages UFIT located in response to the Request. **"Produced pages"** means the documents delivered to Petitioner on May 4, 2026. **"Document"** has the meaning given in Rule 1.350 and includes electronically stored information.

Instructions

2. Produce each item within thirty (30) days of service. Rule 1.350(b). Where a document is withheld on a claim of attorney-client privilege or work-product protection, identify it and the basis of the claim in sufficient detail to permit assessment, as ordinary civil discovery practice under the Florida Rules requires. For clarity: nothing in this request asserts that Chapter 119, Florida Statutes, imposes any duty to create an index or log — the identification provisions here rest on the discovery rules alone. Electronically stored information shall be produced in its native format with metadata intact unless otherwise agreed. This action is entitled to statutory priority under Section 119.11(1), Florida Statutes; consistent with that priority and Petitioner's accompanying letter, Petitioner requests expedited production.

Requests

REQUEST NO. 1. The UFIT search outputs and hit lists generated in response to the Request, produced in native format.

REQUEST NO. 2. The gathered pages — the over 470 pages UFIT located in response to the Request (Hines Aff. ¶ 6) — or, for any gathered page the University withholds from production, an identification of that page sufficient to permit the Court's in camera review of it, consistent with the University's own offer to provide the gathered pages to the Court. (Response p. 3 n.5.)

REQUEST NO. 3. The May 4, 2026 delivery package to Petitioner, including the cover communication and both attachments, as maintained by the University.

REQUEST NO. 4. Documents sufficient to show, in the form kept in the ordinary course, the search terms run in response to the Request, the dates each was run, and the systems or repositories against which each was run.

REQUEST NO. 5. The University's request-processing file for W018463-032626, excluding communications protected by the attorney-client privilege or work-product doctrine (any such withheld communication to be identified on a privilege log).

REQUEST NO. 6. The University's policies, procedures, and guidelines governing the processing of public-records requests, and the records-retention schedules applicable to the categories of records sought by the Request.

REQUEST NO. 7. Documents sufficient to show the capabilities of the search tools UFIT used to respond to the Request, including what fields and repositories can be queried and what outputs can be exported.

REQUEST NO. 8. All communications between the University and UFIT concerning the search for, review of, and decision to produce or withhold records responsive to the Request, excluding

communications protected by the attorney-client privilege or work-product doctrine (any such withheld communication to be identified per Instruction ¶ 2).

Respectfully submitted this 13th day of July, 2026.

/s/ Christopher A. Hanson

Christopher A. Hanson, Esq.

Florida Bar No. 44094

cahanson77@yahoo.com

727-409-5738

Self-represented Petitioner

CERTIFICATE OF SERVICE

I HEREBY CERTIFY that on this 13th day of July, 2026, a true and correct copy of the foregoing was served through the Florida Courts E-Filing Portal and by email on James W. Kirkconnell, Esq., Attorney for the University of Florida, jameswk@ufl.edu, 123 Tigert Hall, PO Box 113125, Gainesville, FL 32611-3125.

/s/ Christopher A. Hanson

Christopher A. Hanson, Esq.